

```
title: Nitish Upreti
subtitle: "Musings on Code , Technology and the Entrepreneurial
world."
author: Nitish Upreti
```

In addition to the basic settings, you can edit third-party settings for integration with services like GitHub, Twitter, Google+ and other social platforms. To enable blog comments, Octopress also supports the Disqus platform, out of the box.

```
github_user: Myth17
twitter_user: nitish
googleplus_user: 110654724815061438236
disqus_short_name: nitishweblog
```

That's pretty much it, to get you started! You can experiment with other values based on your choices and preferences for your blog.

Blogging basics: Getting to know 'Markdown'

Octopress uses *Markdown* as the default format for creating content. So before you can get started with writing your first blog post, you should spend a minute getting comfortable with Markdown. Quoting John Gruber, the author, "Markdown is a text-to-HTML conversion tool for Web writers. Markdown allows you to write using an easy-to-read, easy-to-write plain text format; then convert it to structurally valid XHTML (or HTML)."

In simple words, Markdown allows you to write formatted text without worrying about cryptic mark-up tags. The focus thus shifts entirely to the content. A complete Markdown reference can be found at <http://daringfireball.net/projects/markdown/>.

Continuing with creating a new post, *rake* tasks help you here as well:

```
rake new_post["My first Post"]
```

A new post file is created in the *source/_posts* folder; it has some YAML Front Matter (for Jekyll processing), and you can append the content of your blogpost after it:

```
---
layout: post
title: "My first Post"
date: 2012-09-02 10:07
comments: true
categories: [HelloWorld, Beginning ]
---
```

An *About* page is very common in all blogs. You can add it as follows:

```
rake new_page[About]
```

This creates a new directory *About* inside the *source* directory, with a file named *index.markdown*. This file can be edited for inserting content in the page.

To add the *About* link in your home page, simply append the following code snippet to *source/_includes/custom/navigation.html*:

```
<li><a href="/about">About</a></li>
```

To generate and preview the blog, add the following command:

```
rake generate
rake preview
```

This starts a local Webrick server on your machine. Point your browser to <http://localhost:4000/> for a quick preview.

Deploying your blog on the Web with GitHub pages

Your blog is ready for the world to see. The good news is that GitHub (social code hosting that hackers love) allows you to host your Jekyll-based site for free. I assume you already have a GitHub account; if not, sign up at <https://github.com/>. You will be making use of GitHub User/ Organization Pages to host your blog.

Create a new GitHub repository as *username.github.com*; in our case, it was *myth17.github.com*. Make sure to follow this naming convention, else you will end up with an *HTTP 404 Not Found* error. In this new repository, the master branch hosts the *_deploy* folder and serves your blog. The source for the blog is based on the source branch. To set up the instance with GitHub, run the following rake task:

```
rake setup_github_pages
```

You will be asked to enter your GitHub pages' repository URL, which is *git@github.com:Myth17/myth17.github.com*. *git*, in our case.

You might even be willing to point your own domain to GitHub pages. This is easy to achieve. Under your source directory, create a new file named *CNAME*, and type in your custom domain. In this case, I will have it as *niti.sh*. Depending on whatever registrar your domain is with, point an A record to the IP address 207.97.227.245.

Finally, to deploy the blog, issue the following command:

```
rake generate
rake deploy
```

At this moment, you will receive an email from GitHub, with the subject *Page build successful*. In this particular instance, the blog has been successfully set up on *myth17.github.com* and *niti.sh*. Don't forget to commit your blog